

bank politics and corruption took primacy over safeguarding the security of the country and the picture is complete. Of course, the media too must share the blame for they were vying with each other to show the live action that made the job of terrorists that much easier and, in fact, helped them inflict a deadlier attack. However, the question that remains unanswered is: has India learnt its lesson post-26/11?

H.R. BAPU SATYANARAYANA,
Mysore

Scam Tale

The enthusiasm with which the Income Tax Department and the Enforcement Directorate are working to unravel the Koda scam is praiseworthy ("Poor Little Rich Koda", November 30). In the past, we have seen such enthusiasm flagging after a while and cases have either been brushed under the carpet or allowed to drag on interminably. There are many such instances of corrupt politicians with assets disproportionate to their known sources of income who continue to occupy position of power in not only the Parliament, but also the Government. Prosecution of the accused has often been subverted by political expediency.

J. AKSHAY,
Secunderabad

Koda's arrest seems to be a well-orchestrated blame game. The Congress, for one, is treading an escape route. Ambika Soni's statement that the Congress has zero tolerance for corruption is laughable. Not only does the Congress-led UPA has have partners facing corruption charges, it also has criminal MPs facing murder, rape, cheating and extortion charges.

A. SRIKANTIAH, Bangalore

various measures, the only alternative we are left with is to restrict the speed of two or four-wheeled motor vehicles.

B.H. AGARWAL, Bhopal

Accidents are rampant on the blood-spattered highways and continue to claim the lives of passengers in large numbers. Fully packed autos and overloaded lorries often hazardously ply on the roads unmindful of the lurking



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KANTILAL DOOBAL, via www.indiatoday.in

The Road Ahead

Coverage of critical issues like road accidents in the country was long overdue ("Killer Roads", November 23). As aptly brought out with statistics, plying at high speeds on the city roads is a major factor contributing to road accidents in India. Having failed to limit the speed by

jeopardy. To overcome high petrol prices, naive auto drivers resort to cramming passengers in their vehicles, leading to violent tragedies. The government must allocate separate lanes for two- and three-wheelers on the highways.

IPPILI SANTHOSH KUMAR,
Srikakulam, Andhra Pradesh

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

FEBRUARY 16-29, 1980

The Danger of Secession

"Get out Indian dogs," reads the terse message on a public wall at Dibrugarh, the bustling town in upper Assam. On board the Fokker Friendship from Jorhat to Tezpur, another tea town on the north bank of the swirling Brahmaputra, a passenger looks below at the valley's chequer-board through the dusty afternoon haze, and murmurs something about the "eighteenth war of Independence". The traveller was referring to the 17 successive invasions carried out into Assam by the Mughals, all of which were repulsed by Lachit Borphukan, the legendary general of the Ahom kings of Assam. Lachit is the name that still electrifies the masses. Holding Lachit's banner aloft, the state currently fights its "eighteenth war" against "invading" foreigners. While the majority of the Assamese people still consider themselves to be Indians, ambitious politicians steer the course of the five-month-long movement against "foreigners" dangerously close to secessionism. On January 26, Assam's citizens boycotted all official celebrations and assembled instead at streetcorners to fly atop the same mast as the tricolour, the colour of the All Assam Students' Union (AASU).

by Sumit Mitra

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